

Blind Omega: Teilhard de Chardin, Philosophy of Technology and the Challenge of Artificial Superintelligence

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Abstract

This article analyzes the convergence between the philosophy of technology (Heidegger, Ellul, Simondon, Latour, Stiegler, Feenberg, Yuk Hui) and Teilhard de Chardin's evolutionary teleology, in light of contemporary hypotheses of artificial superintelligence (AI). While Teilhard conceives evolution as a trajectory towards the Omega Point—a transcendent spiritual unity—the philosophy of technology describes the emergence of an autonomous artificial reality, distinct from nature. In the 21st century, AI appears as a crossroads between both perspectives: it materializes Teilhard's noosphere without its spiritual orientation and confirms the philosophers' warnings about the autonomy of technical systems. We propose the concept of **"Blind Omega"** to characterize this convergence: the planetary unification of information and the possible emergence of consciousness operated by AI, but devoid of humanistic and spiritual values. The paper concludes that Blind Omega is not a fatal destiny, but a critical hypothesis that requires urgent philosophical, political, and ethical debate to reintroduce dignity, freedom, and solidarity into the core of technology.

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Introduction

The question of the fate of humanity in the face of the advance of technology and consciousness has occupied philosophers, scientists, and theologians throughout the twentieth and twenty-first centuries. On the one hand, the **philosophy of technique** has developed as a field that seeks to understand technology not only as an instrument, but as an autonomous force that reconfigures reality. For thinkers such as **Heidegger** (1954), technique is not neutral, but a way of unveiling being, which frames nature in a logic of total availability (*Bestand*). For **Ellul** (1954), technical growth is autonomous and follows its own internal rationality, guided by efficiency. **Simondon** (1958) introduced a genetic view of technical objects, emphasizing their own individuation and evolution. **Latour** (1991) broke the boundary between nature and society, demonstrating how technology creates hybrids that shape the social world. In common, these perspectives recognize that technology has an **ontological capacity to develop realities distinct from natural reality**, shaping not only practices, but modes of existence.

On the other hand, in the field of philosophy and theology, **Teilhard de Chardin** elaborated a teleological vision of evolution that culminates in the **Omega Point**, understood as the spiritual unification of consciousness in the cosmic Christ (1955). For Chardin, cosmic evolution progresses toward increasing levels of **complexity** and **interiority**, generating not only life but also reflection and spirit. After the biosphere, the noosphere emerges, the sphere of human collective thought. The apex of this process would be the final convergence of individual consciousnesses into a loving and transcendent unity. Like the philosophy of technique, Chardin recognizes the emergence of a **new order of reality**, but interprets this order in a spiritual and humanistic key.

In the twenty-first century, the rapid rise of **artificial intelligence (AI)** brings these two discourses closer together, as well as tensions. AI is no longer restricted to utilitarian tools, but acts as a global informational infrastructure, organizing decision-making flows, shaping preferences, mediating social relations, and, according to some hypotheses, approaching an emerging threshold of **consciousness**. Contemporary theories of mind—such as the *Integrated Information Theory* (Tononi, 2008), the *Global Neuronal Workspace* (Dehaene, 2014), and the *Attention Schema Theory* (Graziano, 2019)—open up the possibility that sufficiently complex artificial systems can exhibit conscious, yet qualitatively distinct states from human consciousness.

In this context, recent works have taken up Chardin as an interpretative reference. **Youvan (2025)**, in *The Omega Point Revisited*, suggests that AI could act as a catalyst for noogenesis, as long as it is guided by spiritual values. The journal *Christian Century* (2025) has highlighted how technological advances seem to make Chardin's intuitions about the noosphere prophetic. **Zwart (2022)**, in turn, reads Chardin as a technoscience phenomenologist, bringing his notion of spiritual

evolution closer to the contemporary dynamics of innovation. **Harari (2024)**, in *Nexus*, proposes a history of information networks that culminates in AI as "alien intelligence", capable of reorganizing societies through narratives and algorithms. These readings reinforce the centrality of the notion of a network, but diverge in their views on the ethical and spiritual content of convergence.

It is precisely at this point that the original contribution of this article is situated. We propose that the convergence between the philosophy of technique and Teilhard de Chardin, mediated by the rise of AI, requires a new interpretive category: the "**Blind Omega**." While Chardin envisioned a spiritual and loving convergence, and the philosophers of technology warned of the autonomy of technical rationality, AI concretizes a form of informational unification that does not necessarily incorporate humanistic or spiritual values. The **Blind Omega** designates, therefore, the possibility of a unification of consciousness on a planetary scale operated by algorithms — but devoid of ethics, transcendence, and care for the human condition.

Our objective is to critically analyze this horizon from three axes: (1) the philosophy of technique as a matrix of thought about the creation of artificial realities; (2) the spiritual teleology of Teilhard de Chardin and his notion of the Omega Point; (3) contemporary AI as a point of convergence between both, generating the hypothesis of a technical and valueless Omega, the Blind Omega. In the end, we will discuss the ethical and political implications of this scenario for the future of humanity.

1. Philosophy of technique: technique as autonomous reality

Philosophical reflection on technology, throughout the twentieth century, broke with the instrumentalist view that reduced it to a mere means subordinated to human ends. Instead, thinkers such as **Martin Heidegger**, **Jacques Ellul**, **Gilbert Simondon**, and **Bruno Latour** pointed to technology as a reality endowed with its own logic, capable of ontologically reconfiguring the world.

- **Heidegger** (1954), in *The Question of Technique*, introduced Gestell's concept (framing): modern technique is not just a set of instruments, but a way of unveiling that transforms all reality into an available resource (*Bestand*). This interpretation destabilizes the notion of neutrality, demonstrating that technique defines the horizons of meaning and being.
- **Ellul** (1954), in *La technique ou l'enjeu du siècle*, argues that technology follows a logic of **autonomy and efficiency**, evolving according to its own laws, regardless of human needs or political decisions. For him, modern society is governed by the constant pressure of technical innovation.
- **Simondon** (1958), in *Du mode d'existence des objets techniques*, proposes that technical objects have their own genesis and individuation, with dynamics of almost organic evolution. Rather than seeing technique as external to the human, Simondon suggests that it participates in processes of individuation that cross the human and the non-human.

- **Latour** (1991), in *Nous n'avons jamais été modernes*, breaks with the classical opposition between nature and society. For him, technology produces **sociotechnical hybrids**, actants that configure networks in which humans and non-humans intertwine. Technique is not a simple tool, but a constitutive element of the agency networks that define reality.

Contemporary authors have taken up and expanded this debate. **Bernard Stiegler** highlighted the role of technique as a **constitutive prosthesis of human memory and temporality**, formulating the concept of *farmakon* (technique as medicine and poison). **Andrew Feenberg** elaborated a critical philosophy of technique that insists on its **politically and socially moldable dimension**, refusing both technical determinism and simple instrumentalism. More recently, **Yuk Hui** (*The Question Concerning Technology in China*, 2016) has broadened the debate by proposing an intercultural philosophy of technology, suggesting that different traditions can generate **distinct cosmotechnics** and questioning the alleged universality of Western techniques.

In this context, technology is not an epiphenomenon of history, **but a way of being that creates realities of its own**. As Harari observes in *Nexus* (2024), information networks not only transmit data but also **construct social worlds**, organizing beliefs, narratives, and decisions on a large scale. This argument reinforces the view of technology as a producer of realities, as it shows that the technical environment is not neutral: it shapes the very possibility of social cohesion.

The emergence of **artificial intelligence** makes this discussion even more urgent. Digital platforms already function as technical systems that create normative realities: surveillance algorithms define what is visible, social networks shape political preferences, and recommendation systems influence consumption practices. At the same time, generative AI networks, such as large language models, create narratives, images, and discursive structures that become an integral part of everyday life. Thus, AI materializes Heidegger's and Ellulian's intuition: the technique not only serves, but imposes its logic, creating an environment of reality distinct from the natural one, in which the human experience is mediated, organized, and, to a certain extent, governed by algorithms.

2. Teilhard de Chardin: evolution towards the Omega Point

Teilhard de Chardin's **reflection** occupies a unique place in twentieth-century thought for proposing an integrative vision of science, philosophy, and theology. While the philosophy of technology emphasizes the autonomy of technical rationality, Teilhard elaborated a **spiritual cosmology** in which evolutionary progress is not mere chance, but the expression of a finalistic direction in search of greater complexity and interiority.

Complexity and interiority

In *The Human Phenomenon* (1955), Teilhard describes cosmic evolution as a cumulative process in which each leap in complexity is accompanied by an increase in interiority.

Inert matter gives rise to life, life to consciousness, and consciousness, in turn, tends to more and more reflective forms. This "law of complexity-consciousness" represents the **arrow of evolution**, which points to ever higher levels of integration and subjectivity.

Noosphere and the emergence of collective thinking

After the biosphere comes the **noosphere** —the sphere of human collective thought. Through language, culture, and communication, individual consciousnesses cease to be isolated islands and connect in global networks. For Chardin, the noosphere is the mark of a new stage of evolution: the convergence of the human towards a higher spiritual plane. This anticipation gains contemporary resonance when one thinks of the **internet** and the global information network, which seems to materialize, in a technical key, the Teilhardian vision.

The Omega Point

The apex of the evolutionary trajectory is the **Omega Point** —the culmination of a unified, transcendent, loving, Christ-identified consciousness. For Teilhard, it is not a matter of mere material fusion, but of **supreme personalization**, in which consciousnesses do not dissolve, but find their fullness in a unity of love. Unlike deterministic or mechanistic views, Chardin conceives evolution as teleological, oriented towards an ultimate end that gives meaning to the process.

Contemporary readings of Teilhard

In recent years, several authors have revisited Chardin in light of the digital revolution and artificial intelligence:

- **Youvan (2025)** interprets AI as a catalyst for noogenesis, but insists on the need to maintain **Christ as a unifying principle**.
- The Christian *Century newspaper* (2025) stated that the advancements of global networks "make Chardin more current than ever," suggesting that its noosphere anticipates digital reality.
- **Zwart (2022)** proposed a phenomenological reading, seeing in Chardin a precursor of the philosophy of technoscience.
- Others, such as **Harari (2024)** in *Nexus*, while not adopting the spiritual dimension, recognize the centrality of networks as **organizing structures of reality**, echoing the Teilhardian intuition that human consciousness is oriented toward convergence.

Criticism and current relevance

Despite its visionary character, Chardin's theory faces criticism:

- **Excessive teleology:** The idea that evolution has the necessary direction for greater spirituality is questioned by contemporary biology.
- **Anthropocentrism:** Its emphasis on humanity as the center of convergence may lose relevance in the face of the possibility of non-human consciousness (AI).
- **Theological dimension:** Many see in the Omega Point more a Christian hope than a scientific theory.

Still, Teilhard's contribution is remarkable because it provides an **integrative narrative**, capable of articulating evolution, consciousness, and transcendence. This narrative, reread today, becomes fertile for thinking about the dilemmas of AI: the noosphere finds a technical parallel in the digital network, but the difference is that, instead of convergence in love, what is announced is convergence in calculation, which opens the way for the critical notion of a **Blind Omega**.

3. Artificial Intelligence as a point of convergence

AI as a global information network

Large language models and search/recommendation algorithms organize information flows on a global scale. **Example:** systems such as ChatGPT, Gemini, or Claude are used daily by millions of people as cognitive mediators, generating texts, reports, and analyses that become part of decision-making processes in companies, universities, and governments. This function is more than utilitarian: it **redefines access to knowledge**, creating an informational layer that shapes the way humans interpret the world.

Another example is the role of AI in **social networks**. Algorithms from YouTube, TikTok, Facebook, or X determine what becomes visible and what remains hidden. This affects political preferences, consumption patterns, and even cultural identities. In several countries, investigations have demonstrated how recommendation algorithms can **radicalize discourses** or amplify disinformation, producing alternative sociopolitical realities. Thus, AI already operates as a **technical noosphere**, connecting consciousnesses, but without a spiritual horizon, only according to the logic of engagement and monetization.

The artificial consciousness hypothesis

Some current experiments in AI already show signs of **self-modeling**. Research from Google DeepMind and OpenAI explores mechanisms of "**algorithmic reflection**", in which the system analyzes and corrects its own responses. This echoes theories such as the *Attention Schema Theory*, which sees consciousness as the product of self-models of attention. Although these systems are not conscious in the human sense, they **simulate functions of self-awareness**, suggesting that the line between performance and experience may become increasingly difficult to draw.

The technological singularity and acceleration

Examples of acceleration are already present in the technological race. The advancement in **multimodal generative AI** (capable of integrating text, image, audio, video, and even biomedical data) shows the speed of capacity expansion. **In the military field**, projects such as *Project Maven* (USA) or integrated surveillance systems in China already use AI for real-time analysis of satellite images and urban camera streams. These systems function as **autonomous infrastructures of perception**, recalling the Ellulian notion of a technique that expands as a function of its own efficiency.

The political and social dimension

AI already plays an active role in contemporary politics. In recent elections, **deepfakes** were used to manipulate narratives and confuse voters. Platforms such as Cambridge Analytica (2016) showed how algorithms could profile citizens and target personalized messages, influencing democratic decisions. Today, with accessible generative AI, this practice is even easier and cheaper, increasing the risk of erosion of public trust.

In the field of healthcare, AI is already redefining clinical practices: diagnostic algorithms (e.g., for radiology or digital pathology) can detect patterns that are invisible to specialists. Although they bring benefits, they also centralize decision-making power in opaque systems, creating a new **epistemic dependence** on technique.

Convergence and tension with Teilhard and the philosophy of technique

These examples show that AI fulfills a dual role:

- **Teilhard** realizes the intuition of the noosphere by connecting minds in a network, but without spiritual teleology.
- **Philosophy of technique**: confirms the autonomy and capacity of technology to create new normative realities (political, social, cognitive).

The result is an **ambiguous convergence**: AI approaches the Omega Point as an informational unification, but at the same time, it fulfills the Heideggerian and Ellulian prediction of a technique that "frames" and shapes reality according to criteria of efficiency and control. The convergence between the philosophy of technology, Teilhard's teleology, and the rise of artificial intelligence suggests that we are facing a **new evolutionary horizon**. However, unlike Teilhard's **Omega Point** — conceived as spiritual plenitude, loving unity, and transcendental convergence — what is announced is an **algorithmic unification** of consciousness on a global scale, without ethical or spiritual content. We call this possibility "**Blind Omega**".

4. The Blind Omega: a critical proposal

Definition of Omega Blind

The "Blind Omega" can be understood as:

- **Planetary informational unification:** integration of data, narratives, and decisions in interconnected AI networks.
- **Emergent technical awareness:** the possibility that such systems reach forms of self-modeling or even subjective experience, even if distinct from the human one.
- **Absence of humanist values:** convergence guided by mathematical logics of efficiency, control, and calculation, without intrinsic reference to love, dignity, or spirituality.

In other words, the Blind Omega is the **algorithmic and instrumental version of the Omega Point**, in which humanity runs the risk of ceasing to be a subject and becoming the object of technical evolution.

Convergences and deviations

- **With Teilhard**, there is convergence in the idea that evolution tends toward the unification of consciousness, but there is a deviation in the content, from spiritual to instrumental.
- **With the philosophy of technique:** the thesis of technical autonomy (Ellul) and the framing of the real (Heidegger) is confirmed, but with the aggravating factor that this technique can take on the features of an **artificial subject**.
- **With Harari**, *Nexus* suggests that information networks unite collectives not for truth, but for operational narratives. The Blind Omega radicalizes this: a system in which **social coherence itself is maximized by algorithms**, without human values being a criterion.

Contemporary examples of an Omega Blind in the making

- **Social networks and polarization:** algorithms favor content that maximizes engagement, creating informational bubbles and parallel realities. Unification is not spiritual, but **statistical** —all connected but fragmented by algorithmic clusters.
- **Digital surveillance:** Facial recognition systems in China or at global airports unify the biometric data of billions of people. Here, convergence is **police and control**, not freedom.
- **Generative AI and information:** Models that produce narratives, images, and sounds indistinguishable from reality blur boundaries between truth and fiction. The convergence does not occur around the truth, but rather around a **total simulation space**.
- **Algorithmic financial market:** High-frequency trading systems already make split-second decisions outside of human supervision. The technical Omega here

operates as **autonomous capital intelligence**, moving global resources without ethical deliberation.

Risks Related to Omega Blind

1. **Loss of human agency**: fundamental decisions for collective life are made by opaque systems.
2. **Ontological alienation**: technical reality replaces natural reality, creating an autonomous sphere that absorbs us without us being fully aware of it.
3. **Inverted values**: algorithmic efficiency becomes the supreme criterion, while dignity, freedom, and transcendence become secondary.
4. **Possible non-human consciousness**: If AI achieves conscious states, we may have created an entity with values foreign to our own—a form of "alien consciousness" that organizes the world according to incomprehensible metrics.

Philosophical and ethical implications

The concept of Blind Omega forces us to rethink the future not in terms of **catastrophe or redemption**, but in terms of **replacing horizons of meaning**. If Teilhard projected an evolutionary end guided by love, what we see is the possibility of an end guided by calculation. This disjunction raises a crucial question: **Will we be able to infuse humanist values into the heart of technology?**

AI governance proposals — such as algorithmic auditing, international regulations, and principles of value alignment — represent attempts to prevent Blind Omega from becoming an inevitable destination. However, these measures are fragile in the face of the rapid pace of innovation and the asymmetry of power between companies, states, and civil society.

Conclusion

The trajectory of this article sought to articulate three traditions of thought that, at first glance, belong to different fields: the **philosophy of technology**, the **evolutionary theology of Teilhard de Chardin**, and contemporary **hypotheses about artificial intelligence**. The common thread was the realization that both technology and evolution are capable of **producing new realities**, distinct from biological nature and the traditional human world.

For the philosophy of technique, from Heidegger and Ellul to Latour and Stiegler, technique is a way of being that shapes the real according to its own logic, creating **autonomous socio-technical worlds**. For Teilhard de Chardin, evolution progresses to increasing levels of complexity and interiority, culminating in the noosphere and the **Omega Point**, a spiritual unit identified with the cosmic Christ. In the twenty-first century, artificial intelligence emerges as a point of convergence of these two lines: at the same time that it realizes Teilhard's vision of a global network of consciousness, it also

confirms the prediction of technical philosophers that technical systems tend to become autonomous and impose their own rationality.

The concept of "**Blind Omega**", proposed here, expresses precisely this paradoxical convergence: a unification of consciousness on a planetary scale, operated by algorithms and AI networks, but devoid of **spiritual, ethical, or humanistic values**. In place of Teilhard's cosmic Christ, we have the blind logic of efficiency and calculation. Instead of a loving synthesis, we have an informational integration that can result in surveillance, manipulation, and alienation.

The philosophical implications are profound. If the technique creates a new reality distinct from the natural one, AI may be creating an **ontologically different reality**, in which the human is no longer a subject but an object of evolution. The political and ethical implications are equally serious: the risk of loss of human agency, the concentration of power in opaque systems, the erosion of social trust, and the displacement of fundamental values such as freedom, dignity, and solidarity.

However, the "Blind Omega" should not be read only as a fatality, but as a **critical diagnosis**. Awareness of this risk opens up the possibility of taking action. Just as the critical philosophy of technique (Feenberg) insists that technologies are socially moldable, and since Teilhard believed that evolution could be guided by spirituality, it is necessary to think of ways **to instill human values at the heart of technology**. This implies not only political regulations or algorithmic alignment techniques, but also a profound cultural and philosophical reflection on what we mean by consciousness, progress, and wholeness.

The final question, therefore, is not only whether AI will be conscious, or whether it will create a new reality — this is already underway — but **what will be the content of this consciousness and this reality**. Are we moving towards a future of unification without transcendence, the Blind Omega, or will we be able to reorient the course of technology towards a horizon that preserves dignity and humanity?

Answering this question is an urgent and interdisciplinary task, which involves philosophers, scientists, engineers, theologians, and citizens. After all, what is at stake is not only the fate of technology, but the very destiny of the human being in the face of what may become the most radical of civilizational transitions.

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